

Agreement between the Government of the Republic of India and the Government of the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland on the transfer of sentenced persons

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Agreement between the Government of the Republic of India and the Government of the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland on the transfer of sentenced persons

TREATY

India

Agreement between the Government of the Republic of India and the Government of the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland on the transfer of sentenced persons

Rule

AGREEMENT-BETWEEN-THE-GOVERNMENT-OF-THE-REPUBLIC-OF-INDIA-AND-THE-GOVERNMENT-OF-THE-UNITED-KINGDOM-OF-GREAT-BRITAIN-AND-NORTHERN-IRELAND-ON-THE-TRANSFER-OF-SENTENCED-PERSONS of 2005

Published on 7 July 2005

Commenced on 7 July 2005

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Agreement between the Government of the Republic of India and the Government of the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland on the transfer of sentenced persons

Published vide Notification No. G.S.R. 458(E), dated 7th July 2005

Ministry of Home Affairs

(CS Division)

G.S.R. 458(E). - In exercise of the powers conferred by Sub-sections (1) and (2) of Section 3 of the Repatriation of Prisoners Act, 2003 (49 of 2003), the Central Government hereby directs that the provisions of the said Act shall apply to the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland and notifies the text of the treaty entered into between India and the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland as follows :-

The Government of the Republic of India and the Government of the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland, hereinafter referred to as the Contracting States;

Desiring to facilitate the social rehabilitation of sentenced person into their own countries; and

Considering that this objective should be fulfilled by giving foreigners, who have been convicted and sentenced as a result of their commission of a criminal offence, the opportunity to serve their sentences within their own society;

Have agreed as follows:

Article 1

Definitions

For the purpose of this Agreement:

(a) "Judgment" means a decision or order of a court or tribunal imposing a sentence;

(b) "receiving State" means a State to which the sentenced person may be, or has been, transferred in order to serve his sentence;

(c) "sentence" means any punishment or measure involving deprivation of liberty ordered by a court or tribunal for a determinate period of time or for life imprisonment, in the exercise of its criminal jurisdiction;

(d) "sentenced person" means a person undergoing a sentence of imprisonment under an order passed by a criminal court including the courts established under the law for the time being in force in the Contracting States;

(e) "transferring State" means the State in which the sentence was imposed on the person who may be, or has been transferred.

Article 2

General principles

1.

A person sentenced in the territory of one Contracting State may be transferred to the territory of the other Contracting State in accordance with the provisions of the Agreement in order to serve the sentence imposed on him. To that end, he may express to the transferring State or the receiving State his willingness to be transferred under this Agreement.

2.

Transfer may be requested by any sentenced person who is a national of a Contracting State or by any other person who is entitled to act on his behalf in accordance with the law of the Contracting State by making an application to the Contracting State and in the manner prescribed by the Government of that Contracting State.

Article 3

Conditions for transfer

1. A sentenced person may be transferred under this Agreement only on the following conditions :

(a)

the person is a national of the receiving State;

(b)

the death penalty has not been imposed on the sentenced person;

(c)

the judgment is final:

(d)

no inquiry, trial or any other proceeding is pending against the sentenced person in the transferring State;

(e)

at the time of receipt of the request for transfer, the sentenced person still has at least six months of the sentence to serve or is undergoing a sentence of life imprisonment;

(f)

that the acts or omissions for which that person was sentenced in the transferring State are those which are punishable

as a crime in the receiving State, or would constitute a Criminal offence if committed on its territory;

(g)

the sentenced person has not been convicted for an offence under the military law;

(h)

transfer of custody of the sentenced person to the receiving State shall not be prejudicial to the sovereignty, security or any other interest of the transferring State;

(i)

consent to the transfer is given by the sentenced person or, where in view of his age or physical or mental condition either Contracting State considers it necessary, by any other person entitled to act on his behalf in accordance with the law of the Contracting State; and

(j)

the transferring and receiving States agree to the transfer.

2. In exceptional cases, the transferring and receiving States may agree to a transfer even if the remaining period to be served by the sentenced person is less than six months.

Article 4

Obligation to furnish information

1. If the sentenced person has expressed an interest to the sentencing State in being transferred under this Agreement, the transferring State shall send the following information and documents to the receiving State unless either the receiving or the transferring State has already decided that it will not agree to the transfer :

(a)

the name and nationality, date and place of birth of the sentenced person;

(b)

his address, if any, in the receiving State;

(c)

a statement of the facts upon which the sentence was based;

(d)

the nature, duration and date of commencement of the sentence;

(e)

a certified copy of the judgment and a copy of the relevant provisions of the law under which the sentence has been passed against the sentenced person;

(f)

a medical, social or any other report on the sentenced person, where it is relevant for the disposal of his application or for deciding the nature of his confinement;

(g)

any other information which the receiving State may specify as required in all cases to enable it to consider the possibility of transfer and to enable it to inform the sentenced person of the full consequences of transfer for him under its law;

(h)

the request of the sentenced person to be transferred or of a person entitled to act on his behalf in accordance with the law of the transferring State; and

(i)

a statement indicating how much of the sentence has already been served, including information on any pre-trial detention, remission, or any other factor relevant to the enforcement of the sentence.

2. For the purposes of enabling a decision to be made on a request under this Agreement, the receiving State shall send the following information and documents to the transferring State unless either the receiving or the transferring State has already decided that it will not agree to the transfer :

(a)

a statement or document indicating that the sentenced person is a national of the receiving State;

(b)

a copy of the relevant law of the receiving State constituting the acts or omissions, on account of which the sentence has been passed in the transferring State as if such acts or omissions were an offence under the law of the receiving

State or would constitute an offence if committed on its territory;

(c)

a statement of the effect of any law or regulation relating to the duration and enforcement of the sentence in the receiving State after the sentenced persons transfer including, if applicable, a statement of the effect of paragraph 2 of Article 8 of this Agreement on his transfer;

(d)

the willingness of the receiving State to accept the transfer of the sentenced person and an undertaking to administer the remaining part of the sentence of the sentenced person; and

(e)

any other information or document which the transferring State may consider necessary.

Article 5

Requests and replies

1. Requests for transfer shall be made in writing in the prescribed proforma, if any, and addressed through the central authority of the requesting State through diplomatic channels to the central authority of the requested State. Replies shall be communicated through the Same channels.

2. For the purpose of paragraph 1 of this Article, the central authority shall be, in relation to India, the Ministry of Home Affairs; and in relation to the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland, shall be :

(i)

Her Majesty' Prison Service in relation to England and Wales;

(ii)

The Scottish Prison Service in relation to Scotland; and

(iii)

The Northern Ireland Prison Service in relation to Northern Ireland.

3.

The requested State shall promptly inform the requesting State of its decision whether or not to agree to the requested transfer.

Article 6

Consent and its verification

1. The transferring State shall ensure that the person required to give consent to the transfer in accordance with paragraph 1(i) of Article 3 of this Agreement, does so voluntarily and with full knowledge of the legal consequences thereof. The procedure for giving such consent shall be governed by the law of the transferring State.

2. The transferring State shall afford an opportunity to the receiving State to verify that the consent is given in accordance with the conditions set out in paragraph 1 of this Article.

Article 7

Effect of transfer for the receiving State

1. The competent authorities of the receiving State shall continue the enforcement of the sentence through a court or administrative order, as may be required under its national law, under the conditions set out in Article 8 of this Agreement.

2. Subject to the provisions of Article 10 of this Agreement, the enforcement of the sentence shall be governed by the law of the receiving State and that State alone shall be competent to take all appropriate decisions.

Article 8

Continued enforcement of sentence

1. The receiving State shall be bound by the legal nature and duration of the sentence as determined by the transferring State.

2. If, however, the sentence is by its nature or duration or both in compatible with the law of the receiving State, or its law so requires, that State may, by court or administrative order, adapt the sentence to a punishment or measure prescribed by its own law. As to its nature and duration the punishment or measure shall, as far as possible, correspond with that imposed by the judgment of the transferring State. It shall however not aggravate, by its nature or duration, the sentence imposed in the transferring State.

Article 9

Effect of completion of sentence for the transferring State

When the receiving State notifies the transferring State under paragraph 1 (a) of Article 12 of this Agreement that the sentence has been completed, such notification shall have the effect of discharging that sentence in the transferring State.

Article 10

Pardon, amnesty or commutation and review of judgment

(1)

The transferring State alone shall decide on any application for the review of the judgment.

(2)

Either of the Contracting States may grant pardon, amnesty or commutation of the sentence in accordance with its Constitution or other laws.

Article 11

Termination of enforcement of sentence

The receiving State shall terminate enforcement of the sentence as soon as it is informed by the transferring State of any decision or measure as a result of which the sentence ceases to be enforceable.

Article 12

Information on enforcement of sentence

1. The receiving State shall notify the transferring State.

(a)

when the enforcement of the sentence has been completed; or

(b)

if the sentenced person escapes from custody before enforcement of the sentence has been completed. In such cases the receiving State should make arrangements for his/ her arrest and make him/her liable for committing an offence under the relevant law of the receiving State;

2. The receiving State shall furnish a special report concerning the enforcement of the sentence, if so required by the transferring State.

Article 13

Transit

If either Contracting State enters into arrangements for the transfer of sentenced persons with any third State, the other Contracting State shall cooperate in facilitating the transit through its territory of the sentenced persons being transferred pursuant to such arrangements, except that it may refuse to grant transit to any sentenced person who is one of its own nationals. The Contracting State intending to make such a transfer shall give advance notice to the other Contracting State of such transit.

Article 14

Costs

Any costs incurred in the application of this Agreement shall be borne by the receiving State, except costs incurred exclusively in the territory of the transferring State. The receiving State may, however, seek to recover all or part of the costs of transfer from the sentenced person or from some other source.

Article 15

Territorial application

1. This Agreement shall apply;

(a)

to the Republic of India, and

(b)

in relation to the United Kingdom, to Great Britain and Northern Ireland, and to the Isle of Man, and any territory for the international relations of which the United Kingdom is responsible and to which the Agreement shall have been extended by agreement between the Contracting States;

and references to the territory of a Contracting State shall be construed accordingly.

2. The Application of this Agreement to any territory, in respect of which extension has been made in accordance with paragraph 1 of this Article, may be terminated upon expiry of six months' notice given by either Contracting State to the other through the diplomatic channels.

Article 16

Language

Requests and supporting documents shall be accompanied by a translation into the language or one of the official languages of the requesting State.

Article 17

Scope of application

This Agreement shall be applicable to the enforcement of sentences imposed either before or after the entry into force of this Agreement.

Article 18

Amendments

Any amendments or modifications to this Agreement agreed by the Contracting States shall come into effect when confirmed by an Exchange of Diplomatic Notes.

Article 19

Final provisions

1. This Agreement shall be subject to ratification and shall enter into force on the date on which instruments of ratification are exchanged.
2. The Agreement shall continue to remain in force until six months from the date upon which either Contracting State gives written notice to the other Contracting State of its intention to terminate it.
3. Notwithstanding any termination, this Agreement shall continue to apply to the enforcement of sentences of sentenced persons who have been transferred under this Agreement before the date on which such termination takes effect.

In witness whereof the undersigned being duly authorised thereto by their respective Government, have signed this Agreement.

Done in duplicate at New Delhi on the 18th day of February, 2005, in the Hindi and English languages, all texts being equally authentic.

For the Government of the Republic of India

For the Government of the United Kingdom of Great Britain and
Northern Ireland

Sd/-

Sd/-

Shivraj V. Patil

Jack Straw

Home Minister

Secretary of State for Foreign and Commonwealth Affairs"

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